

Welcome!

For Parents

Welcome — and thank you for picking up this workbook! Your child is about to learn how computers think — without needing one. Every activity in here is designed to build computational thinking, one of the most valuable skills of the next decade, using nothing but a pencil and some paper.

Why unplugged? Because the best CS learning happens away from screens. When kids don't have "the computer will do it" as a shortcut, they have to think — really think — about how instructions work, why order matters, and how to spot and fix mistakes. Those skills transfer everywhere: math, science, writing, even everyday problem-solving.

There's no pressure to finish quickly, and no need to be a coder yourself. Sit with your child, read the "How It Works" sections together, and let them figure out the rest. When they get stuck, that's not a problem — that's debugging, and it's one of the most real CS experiences they can have.

You just gave your child a head start in one of the fastest-growing skills on Earth. That's a great parenting move.

For Teachers

Welcome! This workbook was built with your classroom in mind. Every activity is unplugged, standards-aware, and designed to work for a range of kids — from early elementary through late-elementary and early-middle school.

Standards alignment: Activities map to CSTA K-12 Computer Science Standards, including Algorithms & Programming (1B-AP-08 through 1B-AP-15) and Computational Thinking practices — algorithms, iteration, selection, and decomposition. The two-tier format (Basic + Challenge) supports differentiation without extra prep work.

Flexible use: Activities work for individual seat work, partner work, or whole-class discussion. The "How It Works" sections lend themselves to direct instruction, while the Bonus activities are great for extension time. Discussion prompts in each Teacher / Parent Note give you conversation starters ready to go.

License: Purchase covers single-classroom use — print and use with your students as much as you'd like. Please don't share the file outside your classroom.

★ *Happy exploring — welcome to computational thinking!* ★